

The New Year REVOLUTIONS

Are New Year resolutions a meaningless ritual—in one year and out the next? Mark Twain famously said: New Year's resolutions are a harmless institution, of no particular use to anyone save as a scapegoat for promiscuous drunks, friendly calls and humbug resolutions.

■ By Dillip Bobb

It's that time of the year when a door slams shut and another opens and, bleary-eyed and woolly-brained, we are meant to review, reflect, regret and resolve not to do what we did in the year gone by. We seldom succeed but that hasn't stopped anyone from making that list of resolutions come January 1. Here is what some famous people resolved to do in 2008.

SONIA GANDHI

To avoid succumbing to the family curse of making statements that backfire badly. Indira is India, Sanjay's "I am a nobody", my late husband Rajiv's *Nani yaad diladenge* and "When a giant tree falls..." has now been overtaken by my "Merchants of death" remark that everyone believes contributed to the demise of the Congress in the Gujarat elections. My new, New Year resolution is to conduct a major reshuffle of my closest closet advisers, starting with the speechwriters; to ensure the UPA Government does not sign any major deals with Italian companies, increase the number of breakfast meetings with Karat and Co. in the hope that they will learn to stomach more than idli sambar, and start a countrywide tour of all states to remind people that the Gandhi dynasty is alive and

To stay out of Delhi where I am bombarded with **bad advice** from people who were ejected from power telling me how to stay in **power**.

SONIA GANDHI
CONGRESS CHIEF



To actually read some books by Taslima Nasreen so I can sound more intellectual than I look and also find out why she is such a **pain** in the...

BUDDHADEV BHATTACHARYA
CHIEF MINISTER, WEST BENGAL



To actually start walking ahead of Sonia Gandhi at official functions, to **remind everyone** that I am the prime minister, and I have her permission to say so.

MANMOHAN SINGH
PRIME MINISTER

To sign more films than Amitabh, win more awards than Amitabh; **to try** and remove this perception that I am obsessed with Amitabh.

SHAH RUKH KHAN
BOLLYWOOD ACTOR